



POLITECNICO
MILANO 1863

Round Table // CareerService

ASICT @ Polimi

03.12.2025 | Andrea Franchini

About me

- I **graduated** from **Polimi** in **2023**, in Computer Science and Engineering
- Then, I spent the next 6 months as a **Research Fellow**
- In early 2024, I started my **job** at Polimi with a full-time, permanent* contract

*in Italian: Tempo Indeterminato

What's my job?

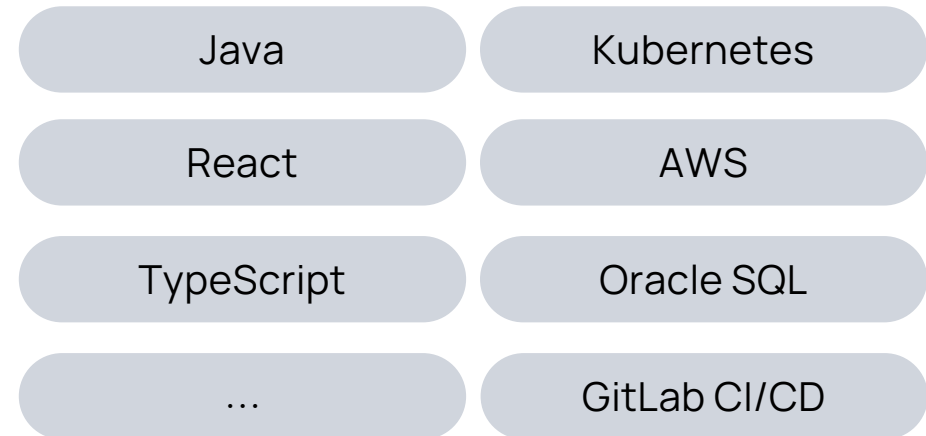
- I work in a team called **Digital Transition Strategy and Integration Framework**
- Officially, I should be a **Full Stack Engineer**
- In practice, **Platform Engineer** describes my job way more accurately
- We're the ones making the technical **decisions** on everything related to **software development** at ASICT
- We maintain and develop internal frameworks/libraries
- We build **CI/CD pipelines** to deploy the software
- If there's a serious technical issue, we're the ones called to fix it

What we do at ASICT

At ASICT*, we develop and maintain most of services you use daily at Polimi.

Not counting external ones, there are more than **300** different active services!

Most of them are built **in-house** and maintained by around **60 developers**.



Our current technological stack

*in Italian: Area Servizi ICT

What I've done

- **Polimi App**: assembling the various services in it
- **CI/CD Pipelines**: automating software releases
- Spearheading **evolutions** for our applications:
 - migrating to **Spring Boot** (after 20 years of a in-house Java framework)
 - re-engineer the Polimi App with **React Native**
- **Mentoring** other developers on **new web technologies**
- Maintaining a fair share of **legacy**, internal core apps
- Migrating services to the cloud (**AWS**)

Roles at Polimi

- There is some level of disconnection between the **Industry**, and the **Polimi**:
 - We mostly have only «jacks of all trades, masters of none» people, also known as **Full Stack** developers
 - For many of them, though, the cognitive load is **too high**, affecting performances
- More vertical, **specialized figures** would likely produce **better results**
 - Of course, it's harder to transfer skills if you are over-specialized on a single tech/library and looking for a change
 - Personally, I'm doing my part to push in this direction

My tips for growth

- **Keep learning:** it's what's gives you the edge to make the best decisions
- **Be lazy!** Don't reinvent the wheel, and for most industrial products, follow existing good practices. Custom solutions are the bane of maintainability.
- **Failing** and **making mistakes** happens! It's the fastest way to earn experience, just try to not to repeat them!
- **Experiment:** sometimes, it's good to try out some new tech
- **Make yourself heard:** if you think you've got the right idea, keep pushing for it
- **Compromise:** sometimes, you've got to accept things for what they are or meet them halfway, if you want to get to the result fast

This is the part where we talk about AI

In case you're afraid of getting replaced by a generative model:

- **AI will not replace (most) developers, just the incredibly bad ones**
 - Copilot & co. is good in certain task, terrible in others (writing code, UI)
 - **Do not “vibe code” unless you’ve already mastered the tech**
- Most people (even technical) do not understand what a LLM is
 - Great to sell “AI-powered” solutions that are still a bunch of IFs
- In the best scenario, they are a **small boost** to productivity
 - ...but you basically shift from writing code to fixing generated code

AI at Polimi

- **LLMs** in general are here to stay for now
- We're gradually adopting them at Polimi to help **administratives** find **information faster**
- **High cost** and **high risks** (**allucinations** and **biased users**)
- **Stakeholders** often **misunderstand** what LLMs are for...
- We've hired our first **AI engineer**!



Working at Polimi @ ASICT

Pros of working at Polimi

- **Lots of chances** of working on a lot of different, interesting projects, with a large user base (**60K** users)
- If you are **dedicated**, and in the **right team**, you can easily achieve a lot in a short time and **leave your mark** if you manage to **voice your ideas**.
- **"Side-hustles"**: teaching assistant, PhD track, external consultancy
- Great **work-life balance** (workday is **7.12h**) and good benefits
- Good salary for an entry-level position in Italy

Challenges of working at Polimi

- Coffee is **not free**
- **Subpar** developer experience (managed old Windows machines, no WSL)
- Lots of **legacy** stuff (some stuff is older than me)
- Weird **burocracy** (not a startup) - trivial decisions may take a lot of time
- Never a dull moment: things **breaks** all the time, and must be fixed **fast**



Thank you for your attention!